



EXPLORE...

FREE

The newsletter of the
Friends of Telford Town Park
Number 2 - 2013



10th Anniversary of the Friends of Telford Town Park

This year marks a milestone in the history of the Friends of Telford Town Park. In 2003 a small group of like minded people decided that the park needed some tender loving care over and above what was already being done by the Parks Department. From that small acorn has grown the group we have today of over 20 members, each of whom bring their own special ideas and skills to bear. The success would not have come about of course without the sterling assistance of the park manager, Nicola Allen and her hard working staff.

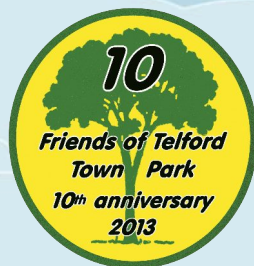
It also needs to be said that we have had constant support from the local parish councils, notably, Great Dawley PC, Madeley Town Council, Stirchley & Brookside PC, Hollinswood & Randlay PC and last but not least Lawley & Overdale PC. Without their financial support via grants, the Friends would not have been able to carry out much of the work that has been accomplished over the last 10 years. A big thank you to them all and we sincerely hope they will be able to continue to support our work in the park.

We will be holding a big anniversary event this year, in conjunction with Telford Green Spaces Partnership, called 'Jolly Green Day'. (see opposite page) This will be a FREE day of fun for all the family, celebrating all that is good about the great outdoors and healthy living. Do come along on Saturday 17th August from 11am till 4pm and enjoy another great free day out in the park.

If you would like to know more about the Friends or are considering joining us, please see our web site for how to contact us.

www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

Cover picture: Cygnets on Grange Pool by the Crannog



are having a Field Day !

JOLLY GREEN DAY

Saturday 17th August 2013

11am till 4pm

***The Queen Elizabeth 2 Field
(The Arena) Telford Town***

This will be a FREE fun filled day for all the family to come and enjoy what the great outdoors has to offer. There will be wildlife stalls, crafts, face painting, birds of prey, walking, cycling, recycling, arena displays, food, games, energy saving plus a grand prize draw for a holiday in Spain to be drawn on the day.

Tickets are available now from members of the Friends of Telford Town Park and Telford Green Spaces Partnership and also from the Bicycle Hub, Telford Town Park Visitor Centre.



RNIB & GUIDE DOGS

benefit from £1,500

Photo courtesy of Shropshire Star

March saw the official presentation to the RNIB & Guide Dogs of the money raised from the 6th Telford Santa Fun Run last December.

Pictured are Chris Pettman (FOTTP) Rowland Brown (Guide Dogs), Daniel, Rowland's guide dog and Colin Thompson (FOTTP).

This year's run, the 7th, will be launched at Jolly Green Day on 17th August. A big thank you to all who took part and raised this much needed cash by these 2 charities.

***New entrance
To the Queen
Elizabeth 2 Field
(formerly the Arena)***



The more observant among you will have noticed that there is now a new entrance to the Queen Elizabeth 2 Field from the International Centre. This access will make it so much easier than trying to get large vehicles down Dark Lane. The Friends were involved in the discussions from the outset and we believe it will be a valuable addition to the park's facilities



Watch This Space! For the new sensory garden

Within the Chelsea Gardens there used to be a rose garden which had become past it's best to put it kindly!

The Friends were asked if they would like to design a new sensory garden with the help of a professional designer, some Big Lottery money and a £5,000 budget. We were delighted to say to the least. Work has now been going on for some months, despite the bitter weather, to clear the site ready for the construction of the new layout. This will include some raised beds, water features and some sculptures, along with many sensory plants for feel, smell or touch. The official opening is planned for Jolly Green Day on 17th August and we hope to have some plants for sale as well, partly from the old garden and some from the old Spout Farm House area. This new feature in the park will not only be of great value to the less able bodied among us but also to anyone who feels like wandering through the garden and perhaps sitting in quiet contemplation for a while.

*If anyone would like to assist us with this satisfying task, then do please come along on the **1st or 3rd Wednesday of every month**. We meet at the **Visitor Centre** and work from **10am till 1pm** when we have a snack and and a chat. It's great fun and very rewarding.*

*We are also very grateful for the support of the **Big Lottery, Dobbies Garden World, Shrewsbury, Blockleys Bricks, Trench, Enigma Imports Ltd, Cornwall, Telford & Wrekin Council and Teresa Rham, Designer, Groundesigns, Oswestry.***



Some dates for your diary !

Bat walks

Friday 17th May 9pm
Thursday 15th August 8.40pm
Meet at the Visitor Centre



Nature Photo walk

Tuesday 4th June
10.30 - 11.30am
Meet at the Visitor Centre

Angling Training

Various dates in **June and July**
Phone for details and to book



Art for Health & Wellbeing

Saturday 13th July 10am - 1pm
Saturday 14th Sept 10am - 1pm
The Visitor Centre

PLEASE NOTE: All these events and many others not listed here are **FREE** but **MUST** be booked through Catherine Anderson on [REDACTED]
Phone for details
[REDACTED]



'Parks for People'



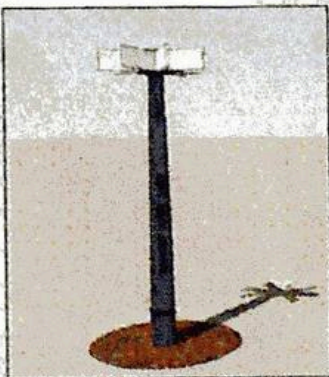
LOTTERY FUNDED

The Parks for People project funded by the Big Lottery and Telford & Wrekin Council now enters it's 3rd year. It is in the capable hands of Carly Burd the project manager from T & W Council.

The concentration this year will be the resurfacing and drainage of some of the main footpaths and the installation of new signage.

The numerous 'gateways' into the park will also receive some attention particularly the main ones from Southwater, Aqueduct and Stirchley. At the same time heritage and ecology trails are being introduced along with a leaflet so that people can wander through the park with a pocket guide and enjoy all that the 150 hectares have to offer; all of it FREE of course!

So what are you waiting for get your walking shoes on and get out into the countryside in the middle of Telford!



Local Gateway Entrances L1 & L3



Come and join us

As we are now entering our 11th year of promoting, conserving and protecting the park we would like to encourage more people to come forward and get involved with some healthy outdoor exercise. Children are also welcome but if under 16 years of age must be accompanied by an appropriate adult. This also applies to special needs adults. All are welcome to come along and help keep the jewel in Telford's crown shining and in good shape for future generations to enjoy.

*We meet once a month on the **2nd Wednesday** of every month in the **Visitor Centre** at **6pm**. Meetings last around 1½ hours. You can also pick up an application form from the Visitor Centre or go online to our web site. You can also leave your contact details at the Visitor Centre Reception and we will contact you.*

www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

Membership is free and tools are provided

